

WEEK 2 ASSIGNMENT PRESENTATION

Product Lifecycle Mastery

From Idea to Market — Understanding the Full Journey of a Product

The Five Topics

01

Idea Validation

Is this worth building?

02

MVP Concept

Build the smallest thing that works

03

Product-Market Fit

Did we get it right?

04

Iteration Cycles

How do we improve?

05

Growth Stages

Where is the product now?

01 — Idea Validation

Is this worth building?

Core Question

Does this problem exist, and are people frustrated enough to solve it?

Real Example

Campus Connect

Before building: Do students struggle with this? Are supervisors complaining? Could WhatsApp solve it instead?

VALIDATION METHODS



Talk to 5–10 real users before writing a single line of code



Run a simple survey — Google Forms costs nothing



Build a fake landing page and see if people sign up

02 — MVP Concept

Minimum Viable Product

If you want to build a car, your MVP is not half a car with no wheels — it's a bicycle. It solves the transportation problem while you learn if people want to go faster.

Real Example — Instagram

Campus Connect's MVP did ONE thing: apply filters to photos and share them. No reels, no stories, no shopping. They proved people loved it, then built everything else.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ✗ Adding features "just in case" — wastes time and money
- ✗ Confusing MVP with prototype — different purposes
- ✗ Waiting until it's "perfect" — done beats perfect

03 — Product-Market Fit

Did we get it right?

The Sean Ellis Test

Ask users: "How would you feel if you could no longer use this product?"

If 40%+ say 'very disappointed' — you likely have PMF.

No PMF Signs

- Users sign up but don't return
- You must constantly convince people
- People say 'nice' but won't refer

PMF Signs

- ✓ Users tell others without being asked
- ✓ They're upset when the app is down
- ✓ Organic growth without ad spend

04 — Iteration Cycles

How do we improve?



↻ This loop repeats — continuously

KEY ITERATION TOOLS

User Feedback

Surveys, interviews, complaint tracking

Analytics

Which features do people actually use?

A/B Testing

Show version A to half, version B to rest — pick the winner

Real Example: Whatsapp scrolling features

05 — Growth Stages

Where is the product now?

Introduction

Getting first users

Growth

Scaling & fixing

Maturity

Retain, differentiate

Decline

Pivot or shut down

Renewal

Reinvent the product

Real Example — BlackBerry

Introduction in 2000s → Growth with BBM → Maturity as smartphones rose → Decline when Android/iPhone took over → Attempted Renewal by switching to software.

All 5 stages — one company.

Real Example — Facebook / Meta

Facebook is in the Maturity stage in the West — growth has slowed, so they focus on retention. To find Growth, they acquired WhatsApp and Instagram — new markets, new products.

5 Questions

1

What is the difference between an MVP and a prototype?

2

30 out of 100 users say they'd be 'very disappointed' if your student portal shut down. Do you have PMF? Why or why not?

3

Look at your X3 Lab initiative — write 3 bullet points on what lifecycle stage it's in and why.

Key Takeaway

Understanding the product lifecycle is not just theory — it's how great products get built.

Every product you will ever build or manage will follow these stages. The best product managers don't guess — they know which stage they're in and act accordingly.